

NUTS *various*

With some trees providing architectural garden value and others beautiful spring blossoms, nuts are not as commonly grown as they ought to be. In temperate climates, a range of nuts can be homegrown: walnuts, hazelnuts (see image, left), almonds, sweet chestnuts, and cobnuts. Don't worry if you don't have a large amount of space, since some, such as almonds or cobnuts, will grow as bushes in containers.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
PLANT				
HARVEST				

PLANTING

If you buy a container-grown tree, ensure that it is healthy and has not become pot-bound. Some nut trees, such as walnuts, will eventually establish very long roots. Nut trees are generally very tolerant and will grow in a range of conditions. They prefer well-drained soil, and a pH of around 6.5.

It is important, however, to ensure that you give trees enough space to grow—walnuts, for example, will need to be planted at least 40–60 ft (12–18 m) away from other crops, since their roots inhibit the growth of other plants. Sweet chestnut trees will also grow large if permitted and will need a space of at least 25 ft (8 m). Cobnuts and almonds can be



Almond nuts (left) and blossom (right).

trained as fans, but will still need space; give cobnuts 15 ft (4.5 m), and almonds 15–20 ft (4.5–6 m). Stake young trees for the first few years of growth. Almonds and cobnuts are suitable for growing in containers as bushes.

CROP CARE

Keep trees well-watered, especially if the weather is dry, and feed with a balanced fertilizer